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historic significance was the formal presentation to President Millerand at the Elysee Palace, on September 29, of the credentials of the newly-appointed German ambassador, thus restoring the diplomatic relations of France and Germany to the pre-war basis. The ambassador declared that he would devote his efforts to the favorable development of the relations between the two countries along the lines of the Treaty of Versailles, and President Millerand, in reply, assured him that the policy of France toward Germany would be inspired by the same idea, because the loyal execution of the solemn pact which put an end to the war is the only means for the practical solution of the grave difficulties between the two nations.

EDUCATIONAL FORUM

THE HANDLEY SCHOOLS, WINCHESTER, VA.

Dear Sir: I am the president of the Handley board of trustees and have seen the editorial in your journal. You have received a distorted impression of the situation here.

The common council of Winchester has not voted against the plan for the ultimate application of the Handley fund to school purposes, and the common council has no legal authority to nullify this plan.

More than twenty years ago, when Winchester was informed that Judge Handley had made this large bequest for school purposes, the common council asked the legislature to create a board of trustees to conserve, invest and manage the Handley fund and to formulate a plan for its ultimate application to school purposes.

The Virginia legislature enacted a law that incorporated the Handley board of trustees. This board consists of nine members and three of these members are elected every three years by the common council.* This provision prevents any temporary change in the common council finding expression in a reversal of the policy of the Handley board of trustees, as no more than three new members can be introduced at one time into that board.

The Supreme Court of Appeals of Virginia determined that the Handley board of trustees had been substituted for the common council as the mouthpiece of the people of Winchester in the conservation and development of this fund. The court said that the council had been entirely removed from any control of the fund, except to approve the plan for the ultimate application of the fund, and to require reports from the Handley board of trustees from time to time. The council has already approved the plan for the ultimate application of the fund.

The Handley board of trustees enlisted the cordial co-operation of the General Education Board of New York in working out the plan for the ultimate application of this fund of about one million seven hundred thousand dollars to school purposes. The General Education Board made one of the most thorough educational surveys of Winchester ever made in this country, and I take pleasure in enclosing you herewith the report of the General Education Board.

The brief effect of the recommendation of the General Education Board was that the appropriation made by the common council from local tax money, and by the state, should be added to the income from the Handley fund to maintain superior public schools in Winchester. The plan for the ultimate application of the fund provided that twelve hundred thousand dollars be forever preserved as a permanent fund, the interest yield from which would be applicable to the support of the schools. The common council agreed to appropriate not less than fifteen thousand dollars annually and the right to receive the appropriation from the Handley fund toward the support of the Handley Schools was made dependent upon the appropriation out of tax money of not less than fifteen thousand dollars each year. Adding the amount received by the state, there is an income thus guaranteed for the support of the Handley Schools of not less than seventy thousand dollars per year.

After setting aside the permanent investment fund of twelve hundred thousand dollars, there was left something more than five hundred thousand dollars out of which it became the duty of the Handley board to build the school for white children and a separate school for colored children. Fortunately the colored school population of Winchester is less than two hundred, while the building for the white children must provide for at least twelve hundred children. For some years the Handley board of trustees has owned a beautiful site of eighty acres, within the city limits of Winchester, upon which it is proposed to build the white schools. The approval of this site was made a part of the plan and this plan was embodied in an ordinance that was adopted unanimously by the common council.

Under this ordinance the school board of Winchester conducts the schools in accordance with the school laws of Virginia; but the superintendent of schools is selected by the Handley board of trustees and the school board, and this superintendent is required to receive a majority vote of both the school board and the Handley board in order to be elected. In turn no teacher can be selected by the school board unless he obtain the approval of the superintendent of schools. This arrangement was designed to insure the selection of adequately prepared teachers of tried capacity.

You will see, therefore, that the common council has already approved the plan for the ultimate application of the Handley fund to school purposes and there is no legal power now in the common council to reverse its position or to require any change in the plan so carefully prepared and so unanimously adopted.

Temporary buildings were placed upon the new school grounds, and during last winter some residents of the north end of Winchester objected to the distance that the smaller children were required to walk to these schools. Nearly all of the children are within a mile of the schools, but a few are something more than a mile distant from the school grounds. The residents of the "north end" sent the council a petition for the establishment of a separate school in the northern end and this petition moved the council to propose that the Handley board give sympathetic attention to the desire of the north end for a separate school. Supported by all of the experienced school men familiar with our situation the Handley board has explained fully that there is not an amount of money available sufficient to build and operate two separate white schools in Winchester, and that Winchester with its total population of seven thousand does not require two schools.

The plan of the General Education Board contemplated the expenditure of about four hundred thousand dollars for the building of the schools for white children. The

*At the first election three were elected for six years; three were elected for nine years; three were elected for twelve years.

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unprecedented increase in building costs embarrassed the board in its plan to obtain a modern school building, sufficient to accommodate at least twelve hundred children, for a sum less than five hundred thousand dollars.

The city council became apprehensive that the school board and the Handley board would be unable to complete the building projected within the money available and that the community would be required to issue bonds in order to complete the school buildings. The council, therefore, adopted a communication prepared by its school committee, admonishing the Handley board and the school board to curtail their plans and to be very certain these plans could be realized within the money available.

It is true that some of the expressions made by the council in its communication would indicate that the council was opposed to the plan so carefully adopted, but I am advised the council did not intend this interpretation to be given to the language used. In a word, the council desired that the board carry out the original plan in-so-far as the money was available to do so.

After very careful consideration the school board and the Handley board are of the opinion that the very excellent plan prepared by the General Education Board may be realized in its substantial features within the money available, assuming that there be no further increase in building costs.

If the boards were forced to establish two white schools in Winchester it is true that the plan for a superior school for white children and a superior school for colored children could not be realized; but, fortunately, the legal rights of the Handley board have been clearly and firmly established and this board intends to *stand against any mistaken efforts that would deprive the children of Winchester of the superior schools that they should have.*

Frederick E. Clerk, sometime assistant superintendent of the Cleveland, Ohio, schools, is devoting his great ability and fine spirit of public service to the development of the public schools of Winchester, and has already made these schools, even in their temporary building, superior.

It is confidently believed that work on the buildings will begin next spring, and that the stirring vision you have indulged of the development in Winchester, Virginia, of a superior public educational system will be realized.

The Handley board of trustees, the school board and the superintendent of schools are in complete accord in the work they are doing and, in fairness to all of these public spirited gentlemen, I hope that you will give due prominence to this outline of the situation here.

Very respectfully,

Winchester, Virginia. R. Gray Williams.

There are 160,000 words of one syllable in the English language.

SUFFRAGE, TEACHERS AND POLITICS.

BY ABLETT HORACE FLURY

Perhaps much of our "dirty" politics has been due to the fact that the leaders of our young have had little reason to be interested in our government. Our children have been allowed to learn citizenship from those who were personally and selfishly interested. We might just as well have turned over to the saloonkeeper the teaching of the harmful effects of alcohol. Participation in politics will give women teachers an interest and an understanding of the practical machinery of government hitherto denied them.

We may depend upon their intelligence and ideals to allow them to place the general good of the community above mere personal gain. The frequent analyses of children's characters which teachers must make will be of service in distinguishing between the "ward heeler" and the statesman; between graft and genuine public service. The greatest effect, however, will not come from the direct participation of the teachers and the casting of their individual votes, but from their ability to pass along, to the coming generation, the knowledge which these voting teachers have gained at the polls.

All teachers must vote. In their power lies the opportunity to reshape politics and to remove the generally unpleasant connotation which the word has today.

The United States exports in July were $651,381,827.

The following sentence of thirty-three letters is the shortest known to contain all the letters of the alphabet: "A quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog."

BEG YOUR PARDON.

Los Angeles.

Editor Journal of Education: I was much interested in the Journal of Education of August 19, which contained a comment on my discussion at the National Education Association. It was especially interesting in view of the fact that the person who reported seemed to gather the impression that I "pleaded eloquently for a six-year, unified, high school." The fact is, the conclusion of my argument was in favor of the other type of organization. I should regret greatly if my hearers gathered the same conclusion as your editor. My intention was to convey the opposite meaning and to argue for the other side of the case. As the argument was written, and after reading it over since, it seems to convey the impression that was intended.

However, I appreciate the compliment, although I do not enjoy the misrepresentation which I know was unintentional.

Very truly yours,
Harry M. Shafer,
Assistant Superintendent.

Four cities in Texas have nearly 200,000 population each.

State of Washington population 1,350,316; gain 18.8 per cent. Twin Falls, Idaho, population 8,324; gain 58.8 per cent. Point Pleasant, West Virginia, population 3,059; gain 49.6 per cent. Roosevelt, N. Y., population 11,097; gain 90.9 per cent. Mankato, Minn., population 12,409; gain 20.3 per cent. Gloucester, Mass., population 22,917. Amesbury, Mass., population 10,036. Danvers, Mass., population 11,108; gain 18.9 per cent. Ogdensburg, N. Y., population 14,609; gain 8.3 per cent. Rochester, Minn., population 13,722; gain 74.9 per cent. Fairmont, Minn., population 4,630; gain 56.5 per cent. Nashua, N. H., population 28,079; gain 9.1 per cent.

The gross debt of the United States is almost $25,000,000,000.

Four airplanes went from Mineola, N. Y., to Nome, Alaska, in fifty-five hours, actual flying time. Two days and seven hours from New York to Nome is sensational.

SAY "SUSPENDERS," HOWEVER, NOT "GALLUSES."

One dictionary says "gladi-olus," and another dictionary says "gladio-lus," so that you have good authority either way.—Boston Globe.

And if you are speaking of more than one of 'em you have a choice between "gladi-oli," "gladio-li," "gladi-oluses" and "gladio-luses."—Biddeford Journal.

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